

TOPIC 3: EFFECTIVE OFFICE PRACTICE II – THE OFFICE STAFF

1. Meaning of Office Staff / Clerical Staff

Office staff (clerical staff) are the employees who carry out the day-to-day administrative and clerical duties in an office. They support managers and help the organisation run efficiently.

2. Functions of Clerical Staff

- Receiving, sorting and distributing mail
- Filing and retrieving documents
- Typing letters, reports and other documents
- Answering telephone calls and receiving visitors
- Keeping simple records and accounts
- Operating office machines (photocopier, computer, etc.)
- Preparing and arranging meetings
- Handling petty cash and simple financial records

3. Qualities of a Good Clerical Staff

- Honesty and trustworthiness
- Punctuality and regularity
- Neatness and good appearance
- Politeness and good communication skills
- Ability to keep secrets (confidentiality)
- Accuracy and attention to detail
- Willingness to learn and take initiative
- Good organisational skills
- Ability to work under pressure and with others

4. Summary

Clerical staff perform essential office duties such as handling mail, filing, typing and receiving visitors. Good clerical workers are honest, punctual, neat, polite, accurate and able to maintain confidentiality.

End of Topic 3